

Project Kick-Off Checklist!

Team Forming

The first step in starting your project is team formation. Some of you may already have a team, others may be more interested in specific topics. To facilitate theme matching and team forming, you can use the course forum to identify partners, propose a project topic, etc. A team can have anywhere between 1 to 4 members.

Make sure your team has a tentative project plan

Refine and reach consensus on your high-level project plan. Get input from the instructor about your ideas. Make sure that your idea:

- Involves data that you can access with the quantity and quality needed
- Involves interesting questions, ideally with some outside stakeholders (someone other than you is interested in the answer).
- Requires a solution that is enabled by NLP and technologies we study in this course, among other methods and technologies.

Start refining your project definition:

- How much data do you think you need, and how will you get it? Make sure you are addressing an NLP problem!
- What specific questions do you want to explore? Spend some time on this point - it's the key to executing a good project. There are usually some obvious questions you can answer with a dataset, but what are the non-obvious ones? Try to come up with a long list (e.g., 10 questions) and then winnow down to the most interesting ones.
- What methods and what tools do you think you will use?

Some resources to get you started

- Many interesting text datasets are available on the web; you can study these datasets and define your research questions and project around an interesting dataset you choose. For example see:
 - data.gov ➞
 - data.world ➞
 - [datasets from Polo Chou's course](#) ➞
- Many data-driven knowledge discovery competitions are defined and available on the web; you can choose a competition of your interest and compete while defining your project around it. For example see:
 - kaggle.com ➞

